



# ARMADA SOLO CARD RULES

## PART ONE • RULES AND HOW TO PLAY

**PURPOSE** The cards replace predictable enemy instructions with a changing captain's intent. Armada's normal rules still govern movement, shooting, collisions, grappling, damage, scenarios and victory conditions.

### What You Need

- AI-01 to AI-22: shuffle these as the Action Deck.
- AI-23 and AI-24: place face-up beside the table as Reference cards; do not shuffle them.
- A D10, normal Armada markers, and a spare marker for each AI ship's selected target.

### Set Up the AI Fleet

1

**Choose a scenario** — Use a kill scenario or any objective scenario whose enemy can follow normal ship rules. Scenario instructions override cards.

2

**Prepare the deck** — Remove AI-23 and AI-24. Shuffle AI-01–AI-22 and place the discard pile beside it.

3

**Choose difficulty** — Cadet: draw two and use the weaker legal card. Regular: draw one. Veteran: draw two and use the stronger legal card. Admiral: Veteran plus one redraw each turn.

4

**Mark priorities** — Identify the AI flagship, scenario objectives, and any convoy or protected asset before play.

### Core Principle

**LEGAL FIRST** A card expresses intent, not permission to break a rule. If an instruction is impossible or illegal, follow the next legal priority on that card. If none applies, use the official solo priority tables. If still tied, choose the option most likely to damage the player, then roll randomly.

# RUNNING AN AI ACTIVATION

USE THIS ORDER FOR EVERY ENEMY SHIP

1

**Surrendered?** — The ship takes no action.

2

**Grappled?** — Resolve its boarding action, then end its activation. Do not draw a card.

3

**Ablaze?** — Resolve DAMAGE first, even though it is printed last. With no player M+ ship within 18 in, extinguish if able. Otherwise roll D10: 1–3 extinguish; 4–10 continue. A fired ship cannot concentrate on extinguishing.

4

**Draw** — Draw according to the selected difficulty. Discard illegal cards until one has at least one meaningful legal instruction; do not hunt for a perfect card.

5

**TARGET** — Select the first legal target described. Place or turn a marker toward it. Later AI ships avoid duplicating a target unless the card says to concentrate fire, all eligible targets are assigned, or the shared target is within 10 in and can be fired upon.

6

**HELM** — Choose the speed and shortest legal course that best fulfils the card. Avoid terrain, friendly ships and collisions where possible. Medium and larger ships avoid shallows where possible. If two courses are equally good, use Helm Tie-Break (BR-07).

7

**Move and FIRE** — After each movement step, check Fire as She Bears and then legal shots. Fire each arc no more than once. Follow the card's FIRE priority from top to bottom. Use Shot Adjustments (BR-09) for a quick target number.

8

**BOARD** — After all movement, check legal targets within 3 in. Calculate the modifier on Boarding Score (BR-05), then roll and resolve the result on Boarding Test (BR-06).

9

**Finish** — Place normal fired and activated markers, discard the Action card, and retain the target marker only until the end of the turn.

## Drawing Frequency

**ONE SHIP, ONE CARD** Draw a fresh card for each AI ship that reaches Step 4. This makes ships act like different captains. For a calmer fleet personality, draw one card at the start of the AI turn and apply it to every ship where legal.

## Small Ships and Squadrons

- They may draw normally, but ignore any instruction they cannot legally perform.
- A squadron does not grapple or use ship movement instructions; apply TARGET and FIRE intent through the normal squadron rules.
- If a card names M+ targets and none exist, use the nearest eligible smaller ship or squadron unless the scenario specifies otherwise.

# DECISION RULES

RESOLVE THE CARD CONSISTENTLY WITHOUT PLAYING BOTH SIDES

## Target Selection

1

**Read literally** — Test the first TARGET condition. If at least one legal target qualifies, stop there.

2

**Resolve “closest”** — Measure base-to-base in a direct line. Resolve equal distance by the better firing opportunity, then greater points value, then D10.

3

**Track assignments** — An enemy M, L or XL ship claims its chosen target for the turn. Grappled player ships count as already assigned.

## Movement and Turning

- Choose the route that fulfils the HELM instruction with the fewest turns and least total deviation.
- Never deliberately leave the table unless the scenario or card instructs withdrawal or escape.
- When two or more legal courses fulfil HELM equally well, use Helm Tie-Break (BR-07). Test its priorities in order and stop as soon as one separates the courses.

## Firing Timing

- During a movement step, fire immediately if a point-blank or raking opportunity will be lost before the step ends.
- Wait until the end of the movement step if the same target and same or better shot will remain.
- At the end of each step, fire any legal unused arc. Never fire into grappled ships.
- For ordinary priorities: regular or inexperienced crews choose the closest legal non-squadron target. Veteran crews test Skill; on success use the card's priority, otherwise choose as regular crew.
- For any shot, use Shot Adjustments (BR-09): start at 6 and add every listed adjustment. The result is the D10 target number. The card changes no shooting rule; its signs are direct adjustments to the target number.

## Boarding Score and Test

Use Boarding Score (BR-05) to compare crew strength, damage remaining to Nv and crew quality. Add the three modifiers. Then use Boarding Test (BR-06) to roll the D10 and decide whether the AI initiates boarding.

| TOTAL SCORE | AI BOARDING DECISION            |
|-------------|---------------------------------|
| -2 or less  | Do not board.                   |
| -1          | Board only on a D10 roll of 10. |
| 0           | Board on 9+.                    |
| +1          | Board on 8+.                    |
| +2          | Board on 6+.                    |
| +3 or more  | Board automatically.            |

# CARD LIBRARY AND PRIORITY

KEEP PROCEDURAL CARDS FACE-UP AND SEPARATE FROM THE ACTION DECK

**CURRENT SET** Keep the 22 Action cards unchanged. Put BR-01 to BR-04 and BR-09 face-up as the usual working row. Keep BR-05 to BR-08 together in one nearby lookup stack, pulling Boarding Score and Boarding Test together when boarding becomes possible. Keep the Rules Reference deck as a separate indexed lookup stack; retrieve only the situational cards needed for the battle.

**CARD SIZES** Action, Bridge, fleet and special-rule cards use 63.5 × 88.9 mm poker format. Scenario Reference and map cards use the larger 70 × 120 mm tarot format. Retrieve only the selected scenario group and its matching map, so the larger cards do not materially increase table space.

## Bridge Reference Set

|                                 |                                                                                                                                                  |
|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| BR-01 — ACTIVATION<br>SEQUENCE  | Surrendered → grappled → damage control → draw → target → helm → movement/fire → board → discard.                                                |
| BR-02 — TARGET DECISION<br>TREE | Leading arc and range checks, target assignment, M+ fallback, closest/tie resolution.                                                            |
| BR-03 — HELM DECISION<br>TREE   | Speed choice, shortest legal route, terrain and collision avoidance, final facing; sends equal courses to BR-07.                                 |
| BR-04 — FIRE DECISION<br>TREE   | Fire as She Bears timing, end-of-step check, crew quality, arc use and target priorities.                                                        |
| BR-05 — BOARDING SCORE          | Three lookup tables produce a modifier from crew strength, damage remaining to Nv and crew quality.                                              |
| BR-06 — BOARDING TEST           | References BR-05, checks legality, converts the score to a D10 decision and resolves boarding.                                                   |
| BR-07 — HELM TIE-BREAK          | For equally good legal courses: legal shot, loaded arc, hazard avoidance and fewest turns. Final tie: Roll D10: Odd to Port; Even to Starboard.  |
| BR-08 — EDGE CASES              | Illegal instruction, no eligible target, table edge, objectives, squadrons, contradictory instructions and final tie-break.                      |
| BR-09 — SHOT ADJUSTMENTS        | Start from 6 and add the listed weapon, range, crew, speed, size, visibility, snap-fire and evasion adjustments to obtain the D10 target number. |

**DESIGN CHOICE** Action cards remain quick statements of intent. Core procedures stay on the face-up Bridge references, preserving readable type and allowing procedural changes without rebuilding the Action Deck.

# RULES REFERENCE DECK

RR-01 TO RR-17 • OFFICIAL RULE AND FAQ SHORTCUTS

**HOW TO USE** These are indexed table aids, not extra rules and not an AI deck. Keep them in RR order. Pull only the cards relevant to the current situation; return them after resolution. The current rulebook and FAQ always prevail.

## Core and Situational Cards

|       |                             |       |                          |
|-------|-----------------------------|-------|--------------------------|
| RR-01 | Speed & Movement            | RR-10 | Ongoing Grapples         |
| RR-02 | Collision & Evade           | RR-11 | Skill Tests & Re-rolls   |
| RR-03 | Collision Damage            | RR-12 | Squadrons & Fliers       |
| RR-04 | Fire as She Bears           | RR-13 | Full Wind & Tacking      |
| RR-05 | Visibility, Arcs & Range    | RR-14 | Terrain & Grounding      |
| RR-06 | Damage & Raking Fire        | RR-15 | Indirect Weapons         |
| RR-07 | Critical Hits & Blaze       | RR-16 | Repairs & Leaving Battle |
| RR-08 | Crippled, Nerve & Surrender | RR-17 | Fleet Construction       |
| RR-09 | Grapple & Board             |       |                          |

**QUICK TABLE** Usually leave only BR-01, BR-02, BR-03, BR-04 and BR-09 face-up. Add RR-01 and RR-05 while learning; pull RR-02/RR-03 for congestion, RR-09/RR-10 for boarding, RR-12 when using aerial units, and RR-13/RR-14 only when those optional conditions are present.

## Scenario, Fleet and Map Cards

- SC-01 to SC-10 contain setup, special rules, AI overrides and victory conditions. The AI CARDS section states whether to draw Action cards. A named scenario instruction overrides only the conflicting TARGET, HELM, FIRE or BOARD instruction while its condition applies.
- MAP-SC-01 to MAP-SC-10 are the matching scenario setup diagrams. MAP-MP-01 to MAP-MP-18 reproduce the suggested terrain layouts from Mantic Map Pack v1.0; MAP-MP-KEY explains the symbols and suggested terrain sizes.
- Generic AI Fleet cards provide three ready-made enemy forces. Choose one appropriate to the game, keep it face-up and never shuffle it into the Action Deck.
- Sea Monsters are scenario forces rather than a normal builder fleet. Use the Sea Monster scenario cards; the current list builder offers no selectable legal Sea Monsters army list.

## Rule Priority

**WHEN RULES CONFLICT** Specific scenario rule → official Armada rule and FAQ → Bridge Reference → Action card. Rules Reference cards only summarise the official sources and never create a new priority level. A more specific instruction beats a general instruction at the same level. If nothing resolves the choice, advance the scenario, then favour the option most likely to damage the player, then roll D10.

# SCENARIOS WITH THE CARD SYSTEM

## PART TWO • SELECT, SET UP AND PLAY

**SCENARIO PROCEDURE** Choose a scenario group, retrieve every card sharing its SC group number, and place its matching MAP-SC card face-up. Read the setup card before choosing the AI fleet because scenario limits may alter ship size, points or deployment.

### Set Up Any Scenario

1

**Collect the group** — Retrieve all cards numbered SC-xx-01 onward until the group number changes. Add MAP-SC-xx.

2

**Choose forces** — Use the force specified by the scenario. For an ordinary battle, choose a generic AI Fleet card or build an equal-points enemy fleet using the official list-building rules.

3

**Build the table** — Use the scenario map exactly for marked zones, units and objectives. Where terrain is flexible, choose or roll a MAP-MP terrain card and adapt it without blocking required routes or objectives.

4

**Prepare the AI** — Read AI CARDS on SC-xx-01. If it says not to draw, use the scenario behaviour cards. Otherwise shuffle AI-01–AI-22 and use the normal activation sequence.

5

**Mark overrides** — Place objective, flagship, convoy, exit and target markers before play. Keep the scenario cards visible so their conditional overrides are not forgotten.

6

**End and score** — Stop at the scenario turn limit or immediate victory condition. Use the scenario scoring card rather than generic destruction scoring where they differ.

### Using Terrain Map Cards

- MAP-MP cards are terrain suggestions, not replacements for a scenario's marked deployment zones, objectives, harbours, monsters or convoy route.
- If a terrain layout conflicts with a required route or marker, shift the least important terrain piece the minimum distance needed.
- For a random 4 × 4 ft battlefield, shuffle MAP-MP-01–18 and draw one. For a simpler game, remove layouts containing a harbour or several narrow channels.
- Use the north marker consistently. Rotating the whole map is allowed when both sides agree or the scenario requires different table edges.

# ORIGINAL SOLO SCENARIOS

SC-01 TO SC-04 • FROM THE FEBRUARY 2021 SOLO GUIDE

## SC-01 — SLAY THE MONSTERS

Use MAP-SC-01 and all six STM cards. Three sea monsters follow their own target, movement, breath, ram, boarding and flee sequence; do not draw Action cards. Win by killing at least two while suffering less total damage than the monsters. The 150-point version uses two weaker monsters.

## SC-02 — RAID THE CONVOY

Use MAP-SC-02 and all four RTC cards. Merchantmen follow the dedicated convoy activation and never initiate boarding; do not draw Action cards for them. Capture treasure by boarding surrendered merchantmen before they sink or escape into the protected ocean.

## SC-03 — AFTER THE STORM

Use MAP-SC-03 and both ATS cards. Deploy the player first, randomise enemy positions and heading, then use the Action Deck and applicable official unit rules normally. Play eight turns and use the scenario's destroyed, surrendered and half-points scoring.

## SC-04 — SURPRISE THE ENEMY

Use MAP-SC-04 and both STE cards. The AI fleet begins anchored around the harbour. Use Action, fleet and special-rule cards, but resolve blustery wind and sandbar guns in the End Phase as stated. Play eight turns and use the scenario's 10% victory margin.

## Original Scenario Override

**AUTHORITY** The cards are table aids. If a detail is absent or ambiguous, the supplied February 2021 solo guide remains authoritative for SC-01 to SC-04. The card-based Boarding Score and Boarding Test replace only the original calculation-heavy AI boarding decision, not Armada's actual grapple or boarding resolution rules.

## Difficulty

- For SC-01 and SC-02, use the challenge options printed in their scenario groups because those enemies do not draw Action cards.
- For SC-03 and SC-04, use the Action Deck difficulty levels from Part One, then add scenario challenge options only if another step is wanted.

# GENERAL FACTION BATTLES

SC-05 TO SC-10 • CARD-DRIVEN SOLO SCENARIOS

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SC-05 — FLEET ENGAGEMENT    | Use MAP-SC-05. Equal-point fleets fight for eight turns. The AI uses a generic AI Fleet card and Action cards without an objective override. Score destroyed, surrendered and heavily damaged ships.                                     |
| SC-06 — SEIZE THE CHANNEL   | Use MAP-SC-06 and three centre objectives. The AI follows Action cards while it has a legal shot; with no shot, its scenario rule redirects HELM toward the nearest uncontrolled marker. Score control plus normal losses.               |
| SC-07 — BREAKTHROUGH        | Use MAP-SC-07. The player attempts to escape across the AI edge. When a player ship can escape next turn, the scenario TARGET priority overrides the Action card. Victory depends on the points value escaped.                           |
| SC-08 — HUNT THE FLAGSHIP   | Use MAP-SC-08 and mark both flagships. A legal player flagship becomes the AI's first TARGET priority; other instructions remain normal. Destroying or forcing surrender of the enemy flagship earns the scenario bonus.                 |
| SC-09 — HOLD THE ANCHORAGES | Use MAP-SC-09 and two anchorage markers. With no legal shot, the scenario redirects AI HELM toward an anchorage it does not control. Score control at the stated End Phases, then add normal losses.                                     |
| SC-10 — FIGHTING WITHDRAWAL | Use MAP-SC-10. The player withdraws toward the south edge while the AI attacks from the east. A player ship able to escape next turn becomes the scenario TARGET priority. Score escaped points against destroyed or surrendered points. |

## Scenario Override Test

1

**Check the trigger** — Does the scenario state that its TARGET, HELM, FIRE or BOARD priority applies now?

2

**Apply only that override** — Replace the conflicting section of the Action card; retain every other legal instruction on the card.

3

**Return to the card** — As soon as the condition stops applying, use Action cards normally again.

## Recommended First Games

- Learn the deck with SC-05 Fleet Engagement at 100 or 150 points.
- Add objectives with SC-06 or SC-09 once TARGET and HELM decisions feel natural.
- Use SC-07, SC-08 or SC-10 for stronger scenario-driven behaviour and sharper target overrides.



# ADVANCED SOLO MODE

## PART THREE • OPTIONAL FLEET PERSONALITY WITHOUT EXTRA CALCULATION

**KEEP IT QUICK** The normal card system remains the default. Advanced Mode adds one Fleet Doctrine chosen before play and one Command Roll at the start of each AI turn. It adds no ship statistics, extra attacks, action points, event deck or ship-by-ship decision tree.

### Set Up Advanced Mode

- Choose one Fleet Doctrine below before play, or roll D10. It remains in effect for the whole game.
- Keep the normal Cadet, Regular, Veteran or Admiral difficulty. Advanced Mode changes personality, not power.
- At the start of each AI turn, roll D10 once on Command Roll. Apply that order to the whole fleet until the end of the turn.

### Fleet Doctrine — Persistent Tie-Breaker

| D10  | DOCTRINE   | USE ONLY WHEN LEGAL CHOICES ARE TIED                                                                |
|------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1-2  | GUNNERY    | Preserve the strongest loaded arc and the longer useful firing range.                               |
| 3-4  | BOARDING   | Choose the route or eligible target that best creates a legal grapple or boarding opportunity.      |
| 5-6  | RAIDER     | Prefer an unassigned support ship, squadron or scenario objective over a straight battle-line duel. |
| 7-8  | GUARDIAN   | Prefer the threat nearest the AI flagship, protected asset or controlled objective.                 |
| 9-10 | RELENTLESS | Prefer the legal enemy ship closest to surrender; if still tied, choose the higher-points target.   |

### Command Roll — One Turn Only

| D10  | ORDER               | EFFECT UNTIL THE END OF THIS AI TURN                                                                                                               |
|------|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1-4  | STANDING ORDERS     | No extra effect. Resolve Action cards normally.                                                                                                    |
| 5-6  | CONCENTRATE FIRE    | AI M+ ships may share an assigned target. Where the card leaves targets tied, choose the legal ship closest to surrender.                          |
| 7    | PRESS THE ATTACK    | Where HELM choices are tied, choose the legal course that ends closer or at the greater speed. Normal grapple and Boarding Test rules still apply. |
| 8    | PRESENT BROADSIDES  | Where routes or final facings are tied, choose the one offering the strongest legal unused firing arc.                                             |
| 9-10 | PROTECT THE MISSION | Where TARGET or HELM choices are tied, favour the scenario objective, flagship, convoy or protected asset. With none in play, use Standing Orders. |

### Fast Resolution and Priority

**FAST RULE** Scenario instructions still override everything. Read the Action card normally; apply the Command only where stated and the Doctrine only to a remaining tie. If either has no meaningful legal effect, ignore it—never redraw, reroll or force it. The extra decision should take about ten seconds; if it slows play, use the Doctrine alone or return to normal rules.